DRAFT

Small Animal Emergency Evacuation

Prepare to leave safely with every household pet and care for them during a three-day displacement. This guide is for La Habra Heights Fire Watch members and residents with dogs, cats, birds, and other non-livestock pets.

✕ DANGER — STOP NOW

Leave immediate danger. Take pets you can safely reach, but never delay escape to search for or capture an animal. Do not enter smoke, floodwater, damaged buildings, contaminated areas, or closed evacuation zones. From safety, tell emergency officials about animals left behind. Call 911 for immediate threats to human life.

THE PLAN AT A GLANCE

1. **Prepare now.** Assign handlers and backups, practice loading, identify destinations, and pack supplies for each pet.
2. **Act early.** When authorities advise preparation, bring pets into a safe, accessible area if it is safe to do so. Ready carriers and transport before conditions worsen.
3. **Leave as directed.** Use current official routes and instructions. Load pets securely and take their supplies and records.

MATCH YOUR ACTION TO THE HAZARD

Emergency	What to do
Fire	For a building fire, get out immediately. For a nearby wildfire, prepare and move pets early when safe; follow evacuation instructions. Never return to a burning building for a pet.
Earthquake	During shaking, Drop, Cover, and Hold On; do not chase pets or run outside. After shaking stops, secure pets when safe and follow official instructions about evacuation and damaged areas.
Flooding	Move early along safe routes before access is cut off. Never walk or drive through floodwater to reach or transport an animal.
Hazardous materials	Follow officials' direction to evacuate or shelter in place. If told to shelter, keep pets with you in the designated indoor area and follow ventilation instructions. Report suspected contamination before entering transport or a center.

Fire Watch: help residents prepare, share official instructions, and relay assistance requests. Do not enter restricted areas or attempt unsafe rescues.

Operational owner: Mark Hughes. **Veterinary review:** pending; reviewer not yet identified. **Draft for review:** SAMPLE TEXT — NOT APPROVED ADVICE.

SOURCES

CDC guidance: Pets, Earthquakes, Floods, and Chemical Emergencies. Accessed October 29, 2026.

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Plan Before an Emergency

Complete this checklist with everyone who may care for your pets. Keep the private household plan with your go kit; post only the window notice.

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PLANNING CHECKLIST

- ☐ **List every pet.** Record species, name, appearance, usual location, hiding places, identification, and handling or medical needs. Keep recent photos, including one with the owner.
- ☐ **Assign a handler and backup.** Make sure each accepts the role. Arrange written permission and safe access for a trusted caregiver if you are away. Keep keys and access codes off the public notice.
- ☐ **Prepare suitable equipment.** Have a secure carrier, kennel, cage, or species-appropriate restraint for each pet. Label equipment with the animal's name and your phone number.
- ☐ **Confirm transport capacity.** Fit every pet, person, and essential supply in the planned vehicle safely. Arrange a backup driver and vehicle; do not rely on a later return trip.
- ☐ **Choose destinations and two routes.** Include a backup outside the affected area. Check accepted species, required equipment, and care arrangements. Review the City's Be Informed page for official alert information.
- ☐ **Prepare health records.** Keep vaccination and medication records, microchip details, ownership information, veterinary contacts, and care instructions in a waterproof pouch, with an offline digital copy.
- ☐ **Practice.** Rehearse calm carrier use and loading. Time the process and allow extra time in your early departure plan. Update after changes and check supplies regularly.

◎ **LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL**

La Habra Heights arrangements — [VERIFY] before distribution: The planning arrangement is for city-provided evacuation centers to accept small animals on leash or in kennels or other suitable enclosures. Confirm accepted species, intake requirements, and the animal-assistance process with the City. During an incident, use the location officials announce; ask about unusual pets before arrival when possible.

Related binder handouts: STH-006 for the animal inventory and care worksheet; EVS-004 for routes; EVS-005 for transport; EVS-007 for sheltering in place.

SOURCES

Guidance: CDC, Pet Safety in Emergencies; City of La Habra Heights, Be Informed. Accessed October 29, 2026.

Pack a Three Day Pet Go Kit

Pack for each pet's full food, water, medication, and care needs for 72 hours away from home. Store supplies where they can leave with you.

- ☐ **Food:** three days of the usual diet, labeled portions and feeding instructions, bowls, and a manual can opener if needed. Include special diets and species-specific feed.
- ☐ **Water:** three days of safe drinking water for every pet, plus water needed for food preparation or care. Ask your veterinarian about amounts for your animals; needs vary with species, size, health, and temperature.
- ☐ **Medication:** at least three days of prescribed medicines and administration supplies, labeled directions, prescription details, and a refill contact. Ask the veterinarian about refrigeration and power outages before an emergency.
- ☐ **Containment:** labeled carriers or kennels, secure latches, leash and harness where appropriate, and a backup restraint. Pets need space and ventilation suitable for the species.
- ☐ **Identification and records:** current photos, medical and vaccination records, microchip and owner details, emergency contacts, and written care instructions.
- ☐ **Sanitation:** waste bags, absorbent liners, litter and a portable pan where needed, bedding, paper towels, gloves, and cleaning supplies safe for the species.
- ☐ **Comfort and handling:** familiar bedding, a towel, and a suitable comfort item. Include species-specific habitat and handling supplies listed on the next page.
- ☐ **Health and power:** a pet first-aid kit and instructions, chargers or batteries for essential equipment, and a safe backup plan for powered habitat or medical equipment.

PLAN IF DISPLACEMENT LASTS LONGER

Three days is this handout's planning period, not a limit on how long evacuation may last. CDC recommends a two-week supply of pet food, water, and medications in its disaster kit guidance. Keep additional reserves when feasible and plan how to obtain refills, specialty feed, and habitat supplies if return is delayed.

Medication safety: give only medicines prescribed for that animal, following veterinary directions.

SOURCES

Kit guidance: CDC, Build a Pet Disaster Preparedness Kit. Accessed October 29, 2026. The three-day displacement period is the binder's planning choice.

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Prepare for Each Kind of Pet

A leash or standard dog kennel will not meet every pet's needs. Plan transport, temporary housing, and power needs for the actual species you keep.

Pet	Transport and temporary care
Dogs	Use a secure leash and well-fitted harness or collar; prepare a suitable kennel for transport and center requirements. Keep identification attached. Record bite risk, fear triggers, and handling needs.
Cats	Prepare a secure, ventilated carrier for each cat. Practice carrier use before an emergency. Pack litter supplies; open carriers only in a secure enclosed space approved by the receiving site.
Birds	Use a secure travel cage or carrier. Remove unsecured objects that could injure the bird during travel. Pack familiar feed, water equipment, and cage liners. Protect ventilation and avoid smoke, fumes, and temperature extremes.
Rabbits, guinea pigs, rodents, ferrets, and other small mammals	Use an escape-resistant carrier suited to the animal. Pack the normal diet, hay where required, bedding, and familiar feeding and watering equipment. Separate incompatible animals.
Reptiles and amphibians	Arrange secure species-specific transport and housing. Record required temperature, humidity, lighting, diet, and safe handling. Plan temperature monitoring and a safe source of heat or power; prevent direct contact with heat sources.
Fish and aquatic pets	Develop a species-specific transport plan with an aquatic veterinarian or knowledgeable aquarium specialist. Prepare suitable containers and a plan for water quality, oxygen, temperature, and backup power. Do not assume a full aquarium can be moved safely.
Other non-livestock pets	Identify containment, handling, diet, environmental needs, and a suitable receiving location in advance. Confirm acceptance of unusual or potentially dangerous species directly with the site.

Service animals: keep the animal with its handler whenever possible. Tell transport and center staff that it is a service animal; service-animal access differs from pet intake. See STH-006 for planning with the handler.

SOURCES

Species guidance: AVMA, Save the Whole Family; ASPCA, Disaster Preparedness. Accessed October 29, 2026. Arrange individual veterinary instructions for specialized care.

Evacuate and Care for Pets Away from Home

EVACUATION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Follow official protective instructions. If safe, confirm the announced center and route; use your alternate if directed. Do not delay escape to make calls.
- ☐ Secure pets in appropriate carriers or restraints before opening exterior doors. Keep incompatible animals separate. Take your pet roster, go kit, records, and medications.
- ☐ Secure carriers in the passenger area according to equipment instructions. Maintain ventilation and safe temperatures. Never put pets in a closed trunk or leave them unattended in a parked vehicle.
- ☐ Count and identify every pet as it leaves. If safe and time permits, update the window notice with remaining, evacuated, and unaccounted-for animals and the time.
- ☐ Leave by the safe route officials direct. Keep carriers closed during travel. Report animals left behind from a safe location; never re-enter a restricted area.

AT THE EVACUATION CENTER

- ☐ Check in and recount pets. Tell staff about species, handling risks, medical needs, and any suspected smoke, floodwater, or chemical exposure before intake. Ask for veterinary help when needed.
- ☐ Follow leash, kennel, separation, sanitation, and feeding rules. Confirm whether pets stay with owners or in a separate area and who provides daily care.
- ☐ If care is transferred, record each animal's identification, receiving person or organization, location, phone, time, and reunification instructions. Obtain an intake record.
- ☐ Give food, water, and prescribed medicines on schedule; record doses. Provide a quiet area when available. Wash hands after handling animals, equipment, or waste.

Seek urgent veterinary help for trouble breathing, collapse, burns, major injury, seizures, or suspected poisoning. Notify center staff immediately. Do not improvise treatment or decontamination with household chemicals.

SOURCES

CDC, Pet Safety in Emergencies. Accessed October 29, 2026.

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Missing Pets and Returning Home

IF A PET IS MISSING OR STILL AT THE PROPERTY

Report the address, species, number, description, last known location and time, and handling risks to the incident's animal-assistance contact. Share photos and microchip details. Check designated animal shelters and lost-pet systems. A window notice provides information; it does not submit a rescue request or guarantee rescue.

La Habra Heights contracts with Los Angeles County Animal Care and Control. Use the City's Animal Control page for service and lost-pet information. Incident-specific intake locations may differ.

◎ LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL

[VERIFY] Incident animal-assistance contact / phone: _____
Animal intake location / phone announced for this incident: _____

RETURN SAFELY

Return only when officials allow it. Before releasing pets indoors or into a yard, check for damaged fencing, broken glass, ash, chemicals, standing water, and other hazards. Keep pets restrained while checking the area. Monitor their health and behavior, replace supplies, and update the plan and window notice. Use EVS-009 for more return guidance.

SOURCES

Guidance: CDC, Pet Safety in Emergencies; AVMA, Save the Whole Family; City of La Habra Heights, Animal Control. Accessed October 29, 2026.

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Household Pet Plan Worksheet

Keep this completed worksheet with your go kit. Copy the care section for each pet. This is a private planning sheet, separate from the public window notice.

HOUSEHOLD ARRANGEMENTS

Primary handler / phone: _____
Backup handler / phone: _____
Driver / vehicle: _____
Backup transport / phone: _____
Early departure trigger: _____
Primary destination / contact: _____
Alternate destination / contact: _____
Routes / map kept at: _____
Regular veterinarian / phone: _____
Emergency veterinarian / phone: _____

WRITE CARE INSTRUCTIONS FOR EACH PET

Name / species: _____
Carrier and equipment location: _____
Food / amount / times: _____
Medicine / dose / route / times: _____
Last dose given: _____
Temperature / habitat / power needs: _____
Handling risks / hiding places: _____
Veterinary contact / special instructions: _____

CALCULATE AND RECORD THE QUANTITIES

Item	Daily amount for all pets	Amount packed for three days
Food by pet or diet	_____	_____
Drinking and care water	_____	_____
Each medicine and supplies	_____	_____
Litter, bedding, liners	_____	_____

Kit location: _____
Items to add at departure: _____
Earliest expiration / next check: _____

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Animals on This Property

Photocopy this page for emergency responders. Use dark ink. Display facing outward in a visible window near the main entrance.

Property address / unit: _____
Updated date and time: _____
Contact name / phone: _____
Alternate contact / phone: _____

ANIMAL COUNTS AS OF THE TIME ABOVE

Enter a number in every applicable box, including zero. “Unaccounted for” means location is unknown. Add a separate row for each other species.

Type of animal	Still on or in property	Evacuated	Unaccounted for
Dogs	_____	_____	_____
Cats	_____	_____	_____
Birds	_____	_____	_____
Other: _____	_____	_____	_____
Other: _____	_____	_____	_____
Other: _____	_____	_____	_____
TOTAL	_____	_____	_____

☐ **ALL ANIMALS EVACUATED** — check only after confirming every animal is off the property.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Animal names and descriptions; last known rooms, enclosures, or hiding places; medical needs; handling or bite risks; other information for responders.

_____

_____

_____

_____

Veterinarian / phone optional: _____

Update only if safe. Never delay escape or return to danger to change this notice. Report animals left behind through official channels from safety. This notice is not a rescue request and does not guarantee rescue.

Keep keys, access codes, and private travel details off this public notice. Print this page single-sided; leave its reverse blank.